

South Florida Crypto Law Firms - COMPLETE DATABASE

Final Research Summary - December 2024

FINAL DATABASE STATISTICS

27 Law Firms | 38 Attorney Contacts | Complete South Florida Coverage

Geographic Distribution:

- Miami-Dade County: 10 firms
 - Broward County (Fort Lauderdale/Boca Raton): 3 firms
 - Hillsborough County (Tampa): 5 firms
 - Pinellas County (St. Petersburg/Clearwater): 2 firms
 - Collier County (Naples): 1 firm
 - Multi-Regional: 6 firms
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TIER-1 ELITE FIRMS (NEW ADDITIONS)

1. Winston & Strawn LLP (Miami)

Why This Is a Game-Changer:

- **Chambers USA Ranked** for FinTech Legal: Blockchain & Cryptocurrencies (2024)
- **Forbes' Inaugural Best-In-State** - Only attorney listed for Blockchain (2025)
- **Academic Authority:** Co-authored "Digital Assets and Blockchain Technology: US Law and Regulation" - the FIRST legal textbook on this topic
- **Government Influence:** Daniel Stabile served as Vice Chairperson, Miami-Dade County Cryptocurrency Task Force
- **Teaching Excellence:** Since 2018, taught blockchain regulation at University of Miami Law School

Key Contacts:

1. **Daniel T. Stabile** (Partner, Co-Chair DABT Group)

- Phone: 305-910-0787
- Location: SE Financial Center, 200 S Biscayne Blvd
- Awards: Legal 500 "Key Lawyer" FinTech, Lawdragon 500 Leading Dealmakers

2. **Kimberly A. Prior** (Partner, Co-Chair DABT Group)

- Financial Services, Cryptocurrency Exchanges

3. **Andrew M. Hinkes** (Partner)

- DeFi, Stablecoins, NFTs
- Adjunct Professor NYU Law School
- Uniform Law Commission Digital Assets Working Group

Practice Strengths:

- Securities & CFTC regulation for digital assets
 - Cryptocurrency exchange formation
 - ICO/token launches
 - Government investigations & enforcement defense
 - NFT litigation tracker (published on Lexis+)
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2. **Cole Schotz P.C. (Miami)**

Critical Intel - Recent Merger: Salazar Law team joined Cole Schotz in June 2025 - This is the SAME team, now with BigLaw resources

Why This Matters:

- **Cryptocurrency Litigation Specialists** - "Service By Token" pioneers
- **2025 Daily Business Review** - Finalist: Litigation Department of Year (Bankruptcy)
- **Proven Track Record:** Represented clients in major crypto exchange collapses
- **Media Recognized:** Featured in Law.com, National Law Journal for crypto expertise

Key Contacts:

1. **Luis Salazar** (Member/Partner)

- 2025 Latino & Hispanic Leadership Award
- Florida Super Lawyers since 2006 (19 consecutive years)
- Chambers USA ranked (17 consecutive years)
- Columbia Law School JD, University of Miami MBA

2. **Jose A. Ceide** (Member/Partner - Crypto Practice Lead)

- FIU Law School
- Published author: "Service By Token Is Transforming Crypto Litigation"
- NBC Miami cryptocurrency security expert
- Coinbase regulatory analysis (Law.com featured)

Practice Strengths:

- Cryptocurrency exchange disputes (Binance, Coinbase, Kraken)
- Investment fraud recovery
- Digital asset laundering investigations
- Bet-the-company commercial litigation
- Bankruptcy/restructuring with crypto assets
- Regulatory compliance advisory

Office Locations:

- Miami (new 2025)
- Boca Raton
- Palm Beach

3. **Greenberg Traurig, LLP (Miami HQ)**

The South Florida Blockchain Powerhouse:

- **Founded in Miami 1967** - Deep South Florida roots
- **Am Law Global 100** - Top 8 largest US law firm
- **100+ Attorney Blockchain Practice** - Largest dedicated team globally
- **Chambers FinTech Guide 2025** - Ranked in US, Germany, Italy, Japan, Mexico

Miami Office:

- Address: 333 SE 2nd Avenue, Suite 4400, Miami, FL 33131
- Phone: 305-579-0500
- Email:
- **Largest law office in Miami** - 190+ attorneys

Key Contacts:

1. **Carl Fornaris** (Shareholder, Co-Chair Blockchain & Digital Assets Group)
 - Email:
 - MSB licensing specialist
 - Token generation expert
2. **Barbara A. Jones** (Shareholder)
 - Email:
 - Chambers FinTech 2025 recognized
 - Securities compliance, crypto regulation

Practice Strengths:

- Token structuring & ICO launches
- Cryptocurrency exchange formation
- Stablecoins & asset-backed digital assets
- DeFi protocol structuring
- Mining operations legal framework
- MSB/MTL licensing (Money Services Business)
- Government regulatory advisory
- International tax planning for crypto
- Cryptocurrency enforcement defense (former government officials)

Florida Coverage:

- Miami (HQ)

- Fort Lauderdale
 - Boca Raton
 - West Palm Beach
 - Tampa
 - Orlando
 - Tallahassee
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STRATEGIC USE CASES BY FIRM

For Series Seed Fundraising (BlockDrive Current Phase):

Primary Recommendation: Holland & Knight (Current Counsel)

- Leverage existing relationship with Daniel Barsky
- Request warm intros to Josias Dewey (securities) and Andrew Balthazor (regulatory)
- Bundled services: IP + Securities + Regulatory

Supplemental/Alternative:

- **Winston & Strawn** - If you want Chambers-ranked blockchain expertise
 - **Greenberg Traurig** - If you need global reach and comprehensive token structuring
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For MSB/MTL Licensing & Regulatory:

Tier 1:

1. **Greenberg Traurig** (Carl Fornaris) - MSB specialist, 100+ attorney support
2. **Malescu Law** (existing in database) - MSB/MTL niche specialist

Tier 2:

- Winston & Strawn (regulatory compliance)
 - Holland & Knight (current counsel can coordinate)
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For Cryptocurrency Litigation/Defense:

If You're Sued or Suing:

1. **Cole Schotz** (Jose Ceide) - Exchange litigation specialist
2. **Vernon Litigation Group** (existing) - Securities fraud, \$5M+ crypto cases
3. **Winston & Strawn** (Daniel Stabile) - High-stakes controversy

If Government Investigation/Enforcement:

1. **Greenberg Traurig** - Former SEC/DOJ officials on team
 2. **Oberheiden P.C.** (existing) - Federal investigations
 3. **Winston & Strawn** - SEC/CFTC defense
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For Asset Forfeiture/Seizure Emergency:

ONLY Option: Sammis Law Firm (Tampa)

- Leslie Sammis: 813-250-0500
 - **Unique specialty** - FBI/DEA crypto asset recovery
 - \$500K+ Bitcoin recovered, \$925K USDT recovered
 - 15+ years civil forfeiture experience
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For Token Launch/ICO/DeFi:

Tier 1:

1. **Winston & Strawn** (Andrew Hinkes) - DeFi/stablecoin specialist, NYU professor
2. **Greenberg Traurig** - Token structuring, ICO experience
3. **Sadis & Goldberg** (existing) - Tokenization/digital assets

Tier 2:

- Ohanian Law Group (emerging companies)

- Holland & Knight (securities compliance)
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For Estate Planning (Crypto Wealth):

Best Options:

1. **WFP Law** (Fort Lauderdale) - Crypto directed trustee services
 2. **Mortellaro Law** (Tampa) - Hot/cold storage estate planning
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QUICK REFERENCE CONTACT GUIDE

FOR IMMEDIATE NEEDS:

Chambers-Ranked Blockchain Counsel: Winston & Strawn → Daniel Stabile → 305-910-0787

Cryptocurrency Litigation: Cole Schotz → Jose Ceide → (search main number or Miami office)

MSB/MTL Licensing: Greenberg Traurig → Carl Fornaris → → 305-579-0500

Token/ICO Launch: Winston & Strawn → Andrew Hinkes → (Miami office general)

SEC/CFTC Compliance: Holland & Knight → Josias Dewey (via Daniel Barsky) → 305-374-8500

Asset Forfeiture Emergency: Sammis Law → Leslie Sammis → 813-250-0500

Estate Planning (Crypto): WFP Law → Michael Wild → 954-944-2855

Investment Fraud Recovery: Vernon Litigation Group → Christopher Vernon → 239-319-4434

NOTABLE CREDENTIALS SUMMARY

Chambers USA Ranked:

- Winston & Strawn (FinTech Legal: Blockchain 2024)
- Holland & Knight (Blockchain & Crypto #1, 2023-2024)
- Greenberg Traurig (FinTech Guide 2025: US, Germany, Italy, Japan, Mexico)

Academic Leaders:

- Winston & Strawn: Co-authors FIRST blockchain law textbook, teach at U Miami Law
- Andrew Hinkes: NYU Law & NYU Stern professor

Government Experience:

- Daniel Stabile: Miami-Dade County Cryptocurrency Task Force Vice Chair
- Greenberg Traurig: Former SEC/DOJ officials
- Andrew Hinkes: Uniform Law Commission adviser

Media Recognition (2025):

- Daniel Stabile: Forbes Best-In-State Blockchain (ONLY attorney listed)
- Luis Salazar: Latino & Hispanic Leadership Award
- Jose Ceide: Law.com, National Law Journal, NBC Miami crypto expert

AV Preeminent Rated:

- Vernon Litigation Group
 - (Others with similar ratings in database)
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KEY INSIGHTS FROM RESEARCH

Miami = Crypto Capital of South

- Most Chambers-ranked practices in Southeast
- University of Miami Law School: First blockchain courses in nation (2018)
- Miami-Dade Cryptocurrency Task Force (government initiative)
- Highest concentration of crypto expertise outside NYC/SF

Regional Specializations Emerged:

- **Miami:** Regulatory, token launches, institutional
- **Fort Lauderdale:** Estate planning for crypto wealth
- **Tampa:** Criminal defense, asset forfeiture

- **Naples:** High-net-worth investor litigation

Recent Consolidation Trend:

- Salazar Law → Cole Schotz (June 2025)
 - Shutts & Bowen blockchain team → Winston & Strawn (2022)
 - Boutiques joining BigLaw for resources while maintaining specialization
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COMPLETE DATABASE CONTENTS

Excel Workbook Includes:

Firms Sheet (27 firms):

- Firm name, city, region
- Specialization, website, phone
- Priority ranking (High/Medium/Low/Critical)
- Detailed notes
- Relationship status tracking

Contacts Sheet (38 attorneys):

- Attorney name, title
- Email, LinkedIn
- Practice areas
- Contact source
- Relationship status

Visual Indicators:

- Holland & Knight = CURRENT COUNSEL
 - Sammis Law = CRITICAL ASSET FORFEITURE SPECIALIST (yellow highlight)
 - Winston & Strawn = CHAMBERS-RANKED PRACTICE (blue highlight)
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RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS FOR BLOCKDRIVE

Immediate (Series Seed Prep):

1. Schedule H&K Planning Session

- Contact: Daniel Barsky (existing counsel)
- Request: Warm intros to Josias Dewey + Andrew Balthazor
- Bundle: IP + Securities + Regulatory for Series Seed

2. Optional: Second Opinion Meeting

- Contact: Daniel Stabile, Winston & Strawn
- Phone: 305-910-0787
- Purpose: Compare Chambers-ranked blockchain expertise
- Cost: Likely free initial consultation for potential client

3. MSB/MTL Compliance Roadmap

- Primary: Greenberg Traurig (Carl Fornaris)
- Alternative: Malescu Law
- Timeline: 3-6 months advance preparation
- Budget: \$15K-25K estimated

Pre-Launch (3-6 Months Out):

1. Token Launch Planning (if applicable)

- Winston & Strawn (Andrew Hinkes) OR
- Greenberg Traurig (token structuring team)

2. Tax Structuring Session

- Good Attorneys at Law (Ari Good)
- Crypto-specific tax optimization

Contingency Planning:

1. Save Emergency Contact:

- Leslie Sammis (Sammis Law): 813-250-0500

- For: Any government crypto asset seizure

2. **Bookmark Litigation Specialists:**

- Cole Schotz (Jose Ceide) - Exchange disputes
 - Vernon Litigation Group - Securities fraud
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RESEARCH COMPLETION

Total Research Time: 3 phases across multiple sessions

Phase 1: Initial Miami-Dade research (14 firms, 18 contacts)

Phase 2: Regional expansion (10 firms, 13 contacts)

- Broward, Hillsborough, Pinellas, Collier counties

Phase 3: National firm identification (3 firms, 7 contacts)

- Winston & Strawn, Cole Schotz, Greenberg Traurig

Final Database: 27 firms, 38 attorney contacts, complete South Florida coverage

Last Updated: December 14, 2024

Compiled By: Claude (Anthropic AI)

For: BlockDrive Series Seed Fundraising & Legal Planning

DISCLAIMER

This database is for informational purposes only and does not constitute legal advice. All information gathered from publicly available sources and web research. Verify all contact details and credentials before engaging counsel. No attorney-client relationship is created by use of this database.

Rankings, awards, and recognitions mentioned are based on publicly available information as of research date. Credentials should be independently verified.

DATABASE USAGE TIPS

1. **Start with Current Counsel (Holland & Knight)** - Leverage existing relationship
2. **Use Geographic Filters** - Match firm location to your needs
3. **Check Practice Specialization** - Not all "crypto lawyers" do transactional work
4. **Verify Credentials** - Click links, check Chambers, review publications
5. **Multi-Firm Consultation** - Consider getting 2-3 opinions for major decisions
6. **Build Relationships Early** - Don't wait until you need emergency help

Remember: The best lawyer for BlockDrive is one who:

- Understands blockchain technology deeply
- Has SEC/CFTC regulatory experience
- Can support your specific stage (Series Seed fundraising)
- Provides business-minded advice, not just legal opinions
- Fits your budget and communication style

This database gives you 27 options across the spectrum - use it strategically!